

JOSEPH POINTER

AI Adoption and Reskilling Programs | Manager Enablement, Adoption Operating Model, Measured Use | Building and Directing AI Agents

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PROFILE

Most AI investments fail at adoption rather than at technology. I take AI from identified use cases to changed ways of working, and I teach the sessions myself. At TIAA (\$1.5T AUM) I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform, led the team that built it, and owned it from use-case scoping through responsible-use limits, phased rollout, champion networks, and measurement. I ran one adoption operating model across seven Client Services business areas whose leaders did not report to me, and built a separate reskilling curriculum for the population inside a major transformation with a team of seven. Before TIAA I spent a decade building enterprise learning and talent systems for Fortune 500 clients. I am not an engineer. I build and direct AI agents with my own hands, and I can tell an engineering team what I need it to do.

AGENTS AND AI WORKFLOWS I HAVE BUILT ON MY OWN

- **A four-agent interview simulator, running today.** Inside CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), which I designed and directed the build of. Four agents run in sequence with no human between the steps, analyzing a job description against a resume, designing the question set, scoring answers and deciding when to probe harder, then writing the coaching report. I owned what the system is not allowed to decide, which is why it hands a report to a person rather than judging whether anyone is qualified. It is live and in use, and I have not marketed it. Mike Pointer is co-founder and engineered the production backend, the databases and security that made this and Future Me, Answered real.
- **A standing team of AI agents I operate daily.** Each agent holds a defined role, its own rules, and a named gate, including an adversarial reviewer whose job is to attack the output before it ships. I configure and direct them without writing code, and published the methodology in 2026.
- **Future Me, Answered (futuremeanswered.com), live.** I designed the 5-stage discovery framework, structured career data across 922 occupations, and developed most of the application by directing AI, on Next.js with multi-provider AI. It is in use by dozens of people on donated access.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA, Denver, CO. Fortune 100 financial services, \$1.5T AUM, fiduciary duty under ERISA and SEC oversight.

With TIAA since May 2011. Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist, internal Lean Consultant (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

AI From Use Case to Company-Wide Launch

- **Took an AI platform from an idea to a company-wide launch.** I conceived a 9-module AI-powered career development platform, built on TIAA's proprietary AI platform, and led the team that built it, first for a major transformation population and then across the company. I owned use-case scoping and prioritization, phased rollout, responsible-use standards, adoption strategy, and impact measurement. 16,000+ associates had access to it.
- **Seven business areas running one operating model, none of them mine.** I connected seven Client Services business areas through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and moved each from pilot to a sustained way of working. Enablement, acceptable-use standards, and measurement ran from one place while every area kept its own use cases. I set the operating rhythm and the prioritization.

Reskilling Curriculum, Teaching, and Manager Enablement

- **Built a reskilling curriculum for the people inside a transformation.** I conceived Skills of the Future, a digital learning platform for the population inside a major transformation, and led a team of seven across five curriculum tracks of 12 to 17 modules each. It reached 890 unique users and 1,156 views on the internal community.

- **Taught it myself.** I reached 1,500+ associates directly across 30+ town halls, team sessions, and one-on-one coaching I ran myself. Different roles got different starting points, because a people leader and a front-line associate do not need the same first ten minutes.
- **Built the manager-facing tooling with the AI itself.** I produced the platform's Manager Guide in one week using Amazon Q Developer, so the people asked to lead the change had something usable in front of them that week.

Champion Network and Use-Case Surfacing

- **Built the champion network that carried adoption.** I named a liaison in each business area, and the use cases that mattered came back from them rather than from me. The network ran across change, recognition, and AI work rather than serving one program, which is why it outlasted any single launch and put a win in one area in front of the next team.

Governance, Measurement, and Budget

- **Measured adoption as active use, not headcount with access.** I defined the success measures, tracked them in SharePoint, and carried progress, trade-offs, and prioritization decisions to senior leaders through executive read-outs, people-leader updates, and quarterly business reviews.
- **Set the hard limits that let AI ship inside a regulated business.** I explored and prototyped first, then brought Risk, Compliance, and Legal in to set the limits once an idea was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform. No AI-initiated actions. Guided prompts that keep the person in control of every decision.
- **Built and negotiated a \$300K annual Client Services engagement budget with Finance,** inside roughly \$500K of Client Services program spend I administered, then showed what it bought.
- **Led workplace change across six TIAA locations.** I led change management for return-to-office, the Frisco Corporate Center opening, and the Denver consolidation, where I directed the execution of a 44% footprint reduction and hoteling adoption for 700+ employees.

Sales Engineer, Information Architect, Instructional Designer

January 2001 - March 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent Human Capital, Denver, CO.

- **A decade building enterprise learning and talent systems for Fortune 500 clients.** Continuous tenure through a chain of acquisitions. I scoped capability needs, designed the training and rollout, and shaped multi-year implementation plans for Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, and Regions Bank. I architected the knowledge model behind an enterprise LCMS, so one source could serve many audiences.

CAPABILITIES

Reskilling and Capability Building: Reskilling Program Design | Process Improvement and Baselineing (Lean) | AI Literacy and Role-Based Training | Adult Learning and Facilitation | Workshop Design and Delivery | Manager Enablement and Coaching | Champion Networks and Communities of Practice | Learning Measurement | LMS and LCMS Architecture

AI Adoption and Operating Model: Use-Case Intake, Assessment and Prioritization | Pilot-to-Production Scaling | Adoption Operating Model Design | Adoption KPIs and Baselines | Agentic and Multi-Agent LLM Workflows | Prompt Design | Hands-on across Claude, Microsoft 365 Copilot, ChatGPT, Amazon Q Developer, Kiro, GitHub Copilot, Synthesia

Governance and Executive: Responsible AI and Acceptable-Use Standards | Risk, Compliance and Legal Partnership | Human-Review Design | Permission and Access Exposure Review | Change Management | Executive Read-Outs | Cross-Functional Leadership Without Line Authority | SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS AND RECOGNITION

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | B.A. Art, Millersville University, PA
Generative AI Leader Certification, Google (2026) | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class) | Leadership Skills, The Institute for Management Studies (2025)

Three-time TIAA Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026) | Face of TIAA, one of four individuals recognized that month (2025) | Change Champion (2025)